

Northbridge University Module Handbook

Category: Modules | Version: 1.0 | Effective date: 1 August 2026

IMPORTANT: This is a completely fictional university policy created only for software development, demonstrations, testing, retrieval evaluation, and learning. It is not an official policy of any real institution.

Institution

Northbridge University is a fictional institution used only to provide realistic sample content for the Student Support Copilot project.

Purpose and Scope

This document explains the fictional rules for module registration, credits, prerequisites, assessment, module changes, repeats, and progression within Northbridge University programmes.

1. Module Credits and Study Load

Modules carry academic credit representing the expected volume of learning.

- A standard undergraduate module is normally worth 20 credits.
- A full-time undergraduate academic year normally contains 120 credits.
- Students should not exceed the approved annual credit load without written programme approval.

2. Core and Optional Modules

Programme structures identify modules as core, optional, or elective.

- Core modules must normally be passed to complete the award.
- Optional modules are selected from an approved list and remain subject to timetable capacity.
- An elective may be chosen outside the main subject area only where the programme specification permits it.

3. Prerequisites and Co-requisites

Some modules require prior or concurrent study.

- A prerequisite must normally be completed before the student registers for the advanced module.
- A co-requisite must be studied in the same period unless it has already been passed.
- Prerequisite waivers require written approval from the programme leader and are not automatic.

4. Module Registration and Changes

Students select eligible modules through the fictional student portal during the registration window.

- Optional-module changes are normally allowed during the first 10 working days of the teaching period.
- A change may be refused when the replacement module is full, creates a timetable clash, or violates a prerequisite rule.
- Students remain responsible for work missed before a late module change is approved.

5. Module Withdrawal

Withdrawing from a module may affect progression, visa status, fees, or award completion and therefore requires academic advice.

- A student should speak to the programme office before submitting a withdrawal request.
- Withdrawal after the published deadline may result in an attempt being recorded.
- A withdrawn core module may need to be taken again in a later academic period.

6. Assessment Pattern

Each module descriptor states the assessment components and weightings used to calculate the module result.

- A module may combine coursework, practical work, presentations, projects, and examinations.
- Students must meet any component-specific pass requirement stated in the module descriptor.
- The overall undergraduate module pass mark in this fictional dataset is 40 percent unless the module descriptor states a higher professional requirement.

7. Failure and Repeating Modules

Students who fail a module may be offered reassessment or a repeat according to programme regulations.

- Reassessment may require repeating only the failed component or the entire assessment pattern.
- A repeat module may require attendance at teaching sessions again.
- A repeat attempt can delay progression when the failed module is a prerequisite for later study.

8. Progression Between Levels

Progression decisions are made after confirmed results are available.

- A full-time undergraduate student normally progresses after achieving at least 100 credits from the current level and satisfying all compulsory progression conditions.
- A student with 80 to 99 credits may be considered for conditional progression where the programme rules permit concurrent reassessment.
- Students with fewer than 80 credits normally require an academic progression review before continuing.

9. Module Advice and Ownership

Questions about academic content should be directed to the module leader, while registration and progression questions should be directed to the programme office.

- Module leaders explain learning outcomes, assessments, and teaching content.
- Programme offices manage registration, approved changes, and progression administration.
- Formal exceptions must be recorded in writing.

Sample Fictional Module Catalogue

Code	Module	Credits	Type	Prerequisite
CS4101	Applied Machine Learning	20	Core	CS3102 Data Science
CS4107	Cloud Computing	20	Optional	CS3005 Networks
CS4112	Human-Centred AI	20	Optional	None
CS4200	Final Project	40	Core	100 credits at Level 5

Quick Reference Questions

These examples restate the policy in common student language. They remain fictional and are included to support retrieval testing.

Can I take a module without its prerequisite?

Normally no. A prerequisite waiver requires written approval from the programme leader.

How long do I have to change an optional module?

Optional-module changes are normally permitted during the first 10 working days of the teaching period.

What is the normal undergraduate pass mark?

In this fictional dataset it is 40 percent unless a module descriptor specifies a higher requirement.

How many credits are in a normal full-time year?

A normal full-time undergraduate year contains 120 credits.

Document Control

Owner: Academic and Student Services Office (fictional). Review cycle: annual. This document must not be used to make decisions for students at a real institution.